SUMMIT

DEBATE SEGMENT
THE RHETORIC FORUM

Parliamentary Style Debate

INTRODUCTION

- The Rhetoric Forum is a parliamentary style debate category, made to spark meaningful discourse amongst its participants. This category engages the minds of participants and makes them think from new, interesting perspectives. It will inculcate public speaking skills within the participants through real-time matches with opposing teams.

CATEGORY OVERVIEW

Parliamentary Style Competition

- Participants sign up in pairs of two. Each participant individually delivers a 4-minute speech.
- There are two houses: Proposition and Opposition. Proposition argues in favour of the motion (topic), whereas Opposition argues against it. Sides are assigned and cannot be chosen.
- The category has a total of three rounds. The first two are prepped, whereas the grand final is impromptu.
- Prepped motions are revealed beforehand, and participants are expected to prepare both sides for each motion.
- The impromptu motion is revealed with a subsequent 30-minute prep time, to be used to create the 4-minute speeches.
- In every round, only half the teams move forward. The top two teams advance to the final round.

FORMAT

PROPOSITION

FIRST SPEAKER

- Rhetoric (optional)
- Definitions within the scope of the motion
- Need: why is this being proposed?
- Status Quo: what is the current world like in regards to this topic, and what is wrong with it?
- Policy: how would you mechanise the proposed change?
- 1st Line of Argument: the strongest argument that supports your case

SECOND SPEAKER

- Rhetoric (optional)
- Rebuttals / refutations to the first Opposition speaker
- 2nd Line of Argument: an argument that supports your case
- 3rd Line of Argument: an argument that supports your case
- Comparison of arguments from both sides
- Reason why your side wins

OPPOSITION

FIRST SPEAKER

- Rhetoric (optional)
- Rebuttals / refutations to the first Proposition speaker
- Defend the Status Quo: point out mistakes in their framing of the current world
- Counter Policy: find a path for the motion while breaking apart their mechanisation
- 1st Line of Argument: the strongest argument that supports your case

SECOND SPEAKER

- Rhetoric (optional)
- Rebuttals / refutations to the second Proposition speaker
- 2nd Line of Argument: an argument that supports your case
- 3rd Line of Argument: an argument that supports your case
- Comparison of arguments from both sides
- Reason why your side wins

TOPICS TO STUDY

- Latest news; global and local
- Political and social issues
- Pakistan-centric issues

TYPES OF MOTIONS

- THBT: This House Believes That
- THW: This House Would
- THS: This House Supports
- The motions will be revealed later on, in the respective group for participants.